



SMUN 2026

LOK SABHA

Paperwork & Procedural Guide

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NOTE FROM THE EXECUTIVE BOARD

Dear Delegates,

The Executive Board welcomes you to the Lok Sabha committee. This guide has been prepared to assist you in understanding the rules of procedure, documentation formats, and the overall functioning of the committee. Delegates are strongly encouraged to read this document carefully before the commencement of the conference and to keep it accessible throughout committee sessions.

This guide is intended to serve as your primary reference for how debate will progress, how motions will be raised, and how action can be taken within the committee. The paperwork section contains essential formats and expectations that will be used extensively during committee proceedings. The guide also includes sample documentation formats to help you understand the required structure and level of detail.

In case of any confusion regarding procedure, documentation, or expectations, delegates are encouraged to reach out to the Executive Board for clarification.

Delegates are also requested to carefully note the Position Paper submission deadline:

11:59 PM, April 18th, 2026

Timely submission of the position paper is mandatory, and delays will not be entertained.

We look forward to a productive and engaging committee.

Regards,
The Executive Board

PART I | RULES OF PROCEDURE

All committees at Model United Nations conferences are required to follow certain rules and regulations. This section introduces the same, and delegates are requested to read it thoroughly.

ROLL CALL

The committee proceedings begin with a roll call. During the roll call, the Executive Board calls out the names of all portfolios in alphabetical order and delegates are required to respond in either of the following manners:

- (i) **Present** — When delegates respond with 'present', they are given the option to abstain, i.e., neither vote in favour nor vote against a document in substantive voting.
- (ii) **Present and Voting** — When delegates respond with 'present and voting', they are required to either vote for or against a document during voting. They are not given the option of abstention.

Important: All delegates are required to vote for procedural matters such as passing a motion for a moderated caucus and passing a motion for an unmoderated caucus, inter alia. No abstention is permitted in procedural votes.

FORMS OF DEBATE

The forms of debate are broadly classified into two categories:

1. Formal Debate

Discussion in formal debate can be conducted through Opening Statements and the Provisional Speakers' List.

(i) Opening Statements

In Opening Statements, each delegate, by default, gets 90 seconds to speak. If a delegate finishes their speech before the allotted time, they are required to yield it. These speeches are used to give an introduction to the agenda, present a portfolio's stance on it, highlight problems and offer solutions.

(ii) Provisional Speakers' List (PSL)

A PSL differs from an Opening Statement in that it is conducted on a specific topic and is not exhaustive. The total time of the speech, along with the individual speaker's time, must be specified.

2. Informal Debate

Discussion in informal debate can be conducted via moderated caucuses, unmoderated caucuses, Question Hour, and Zero Hour.

(i) Moderated Caucus

Moderated caucuses are of the utmost importance in a committee as they enable delegates to streamline debate. This allows delegates to debate a specific subtopic of the agenda within the prescribed time.

(ii) Unmoderated Caucus

Unmoderated caucuses are a form of informal debate where delegates are allowed to speak directly to each other. They are used to discuss potential moderated caucus topics, to complete documentation, as well as for lobbying and building blocs.

(iii) Question Hour

This form of debate is used to question particular delegates, parties, or alliances on their stances, policies, and actions. It essentially functions as a question-and-answer session, allowing for greater accountability in the House.

(iv) Zero Hour

This form of debate is used to allow Members of the House to raise urgent issues that can be debated upon in a rapid and intense manner. Delegates may use this time to disclose or discuss important and relevant information, reveal motivations behind their actions, persuade or negotiate with other Members to gain support for policies or alliances, and raise new developments related to the ongoing crisis.

Zero Hours serve as a form of debate in which delegates exchange views in a very rapid manner. Delegates are encouraged to speak with complete honesty and transparency while maintaining parliamentary decorum.

A motion is raised when a delegate wishes to lead the committee in a specific direction. The following are the types of motions that will be used in the committee:

1. Motion to Open Debate

This motion is raised to commence debate in the committee at the beginning of the first committee session on the first day of the Conference.

How to raise the motion:

"Shri L.K. Advani would like to raise a motion to open debate."

2. Motion to Begin Opening Statements

This motion is raised when a delegate would like to begin the Opening Statements and hence commence formal debate.

How to raise the motion:

"Shri Rajiv Gandhi would like to raise a motion to enter the formal debate and begin with the Opening Statements."

3. Motion for a Moderated Caucus

This motion is used when the committee wants to discuss specific subtopics of the agenda. While raising this motion, the topic, total time, and individual speaker's time must be mentioned. The maximum total time it can be raised for is 20 minutes.

How to raise the motion:

"Shri Arun Nehru would like to raise a motion for a moderated caucus on the topic 'XYZ' for the total time being 15 minutes, and the individual speaker's time being 60 seconds."

4. Motion for an Unmoderated Caucus

Unmoderated caucuses are used to build blocs, negotiate with other delegates, complete documentation, etc. Just like moderated caucuses, the maximum time an unmoderated caucus can be raised for is 20 minutes. However, unmoderated caucuses do not have a topic or an individual speaker's time.

How to raise the motion:

"Shri Prem Pradeep would like to raise a motion for an unmoderated caucus for a total time of 10 minutes."

5. Motion for Extension

This motion is used to extend a moderated or unmoderated caucus. It must be kept in mind that caucuses can only be extended by half of the original time they were raised for.

How to raise the motion:

"Dr Manmohan Singh would like to raise a motion to extend the unmoderated caucus by a total time of 5 minutes."

6. Motion to Open a Provisional Speakers' List (PSL)

The motion to open a PSL is generally used for debate when the committee is in crisis. While raising this motion, delegates need to specify the topic, the total time, and the individual speaker's time.

How to raise the motion:

"Smt. Mayawati would like to raise a motion to open a Provisional Speakers' List on the topic 'ABC' for the total time being 10 minutes and the individual speaker's time being 60 seconds."

7. Motion for a Question Hour

This motion is used to question particular delegates, parties, or alliances on their stances, policies, and actions. The maximum total time it can be raised for is 20 minutes.

How to raise the motion:

"Shri Arun Nehru would like to raise a motion for Question Hour of the total time being 20 minutes."

8. Motion for a Zero Hour

This motion is used for a rapid-fire exchange between Members. For additional details, please refer to the Informal Debate section above.

How to raise the motion:

"Shri Amit Shah would like to raise a motion for a Zero Hour of the total time being 15 minutes."

9. No Confidence Motion

This motion is used when the members of the house lose confidence and wish to dispose of the government. The government can defeat the motion by proving its majority, referring to the numeric strength of the Members of Parliament who support the government. While raising the motion, the reason should be mentioned briefly. A special majority is required for this motion to pass.

How to raise the motion:

"Shri Sanjay Gandhi would like to raise a motion of No-Confidence against the government due to 'XYZ'."

10. Motion to Introduce a Draft Resolution, Working Paper, or Bill

This motion is raised to introduce documentation to the committee. The name of the draft resolution, working paper, or bill is to be specified while introducing the document to the committee.

Note: Delegates may also introduce a Bill as final documentation. The specific type of final documentation to be used in committee will be announced by the Executive Board at the commencement of proceedings.

How to raise the motion:

"Shri Chandra Shekhar would like to raise a motion to introduce Draft Resolution 1.0 to the committee."

11. Motion to Discuss a Draft Resolution, Working Paper, or Bill

This motion is used to discuss a Working Paper, Draft Resolution, or Bill. Delegates may point out loopholes, suggest modifications, and bring up features they feel are relevant in order to make the document more comprehensive, effective, and implementable. The authors of a working paper and the sponsors of a draft resolution or bill are answerable to the committee regarding the content of their documentation. When raising this motion, delegates are required to mention how they want the documentation to be discussed. Documentation is primarily discussed via the following methods:

Note: The specific type of final documentation to be used in committee will be announced by the Executive Board at the commencement of proceedings.

- A clause-by-clause discussion is when each and every clause of the document is discussed thoroughly. Delegates can question the authors or sponsors of the document after every clause.
- A moderated caucus discussion enables delegates to raise concerns and question the authors or sponsors of the document in their speeches. There is no direct question-and-answer session in this form of discussion.
- A Presentation + Q&A Session allows the authors or sponsors to present their document to the committee, followed by an open question-and-answer session.

How to raise the motion:

"Shri I.K. Gujral would like to raise a motion to discuss Draft Resolution 1.0 through a moderated caucus with the total time being 15 minutes and individual speaker's time being 1 minute."

12. Motion to Move into Amendment Procedure

After the discussion of a draft resolution or bill, delegates may choose to move into the amendment procedure to suggest additions, modifications, or deletions of clauses. Amendments are submitted to the Executive Board via amendment chits. When amendments are introduced, the sponsors of the draft resolution may deem them friendly or unfriendly by consensus.

- A friendly amendment does not need to be voted upon and is directly incorporated into the resolution or bill.
- An unfriendly amendment must be voted upon and requires the votes of a special majority of at least 2/3rds of the strength of the committee to be incorporated.

Note: There is no amendment procedure for working papers.

How to raise the motion:

"Shri Rajiv Gandhi would like to raise a motion to move into the amendment procedure for Draft Resolution 2.0."

13. Motion to Close Debate and Move into Voting Procedure

This motion is raised to move into the voting procedure for a draft resolution or bill. A draft resolution or bill requires a special majority comprising 2/3rds of the committee strength in order to pass. Once a draft resolution passes, it is adopted as the final document of the committee. Once a draft resolution passes, voting will not be conducted for any other resolutions. The voting for a resolution is done through a roll call vote, in which the Executive Board calls out the names of portfolios in alphabetical order. Delegates may respond with yes, no, abstain, yes with rights, or no with rights.

- (i) Yes — to vote in favour of the draft resolution.
- (ii) No — to vote against the draft resolution.
- (iii) Abstain — to neither vote in favour of nor against the resolution. Only delegates who responded with 'Present' during roll call may abstain.

How to raise the motion:

"Shri Guzarilal Nanda would like to raise a motion to move into the voting procedure for Draft Resolution 1.0 through a roll call vote."

14. Motion to Recess

This motion is used to temporarily suspend debate at the end of each committee session.

How to raise the motion:

"Shri Yashwant Sinha would like to raise the motion for the committee to recess."

15. Motion to Adjourn

This motion is raised on the last day of the conference to formally conclude committee proceedings.

How to raise the motion:

"Shri V.K. Singh would like to raise the motion to adjourn the committee."

YIELDS

Yields are used when a delegate has time remaining after their speech in formal methods of debate. Delegates may yield their remaining time in the following ways:

1. Yield to the Chair — The delegate's remaining time is dissolved with the committee time.
2. Yield to Points of Information (POIs) — Other delegates may ask the speaker questions based on their speech.
3. Yield to Comments — Speakers are recognised to make comments regarding the speech for the remaining time.

POINTS

Through points, delegates can ask questions in the committee, clarify queries, point out procedural errors, and more. Points are categorised as follows:

1. Point of Personal Privilege — This point is used when a delegate experiences personal discomfort or inconvenience that hinders their ability to participate in the committee. For example, this point can be used if a delegate wants the Executive Board or a fellow delegate to repeat something. This is the only point that delegates can raise whilst another delegate has the floor.

2. Point of Parliamentary Inquiry — This point is used when a delegate needs clarification or has a question about committee procedure.
3. Point of Information — This point is used when a delegate wishes to ask another delegate a question after they complete their speech, or at any point in committee.
4. Point of Order — This point is used when an error has been committed in the rules of procedure by the Executive Board.
5. Right to Reply — A right to reply is used by a delegate to comment or reply when they feel their integrity has been compromised due to personal allegations or insults made by any other member in the committee. If a Right to Reply is granted, the delegate will be allowed to speak immediately, outside the list of speakers.

PART II | PAPERWORK GUIDELINES

A. POSITION PAPER

Most Model UN committees require delegates to submit a write-up before the commencement of committee proceedings. This is called a position paper. It is an opportunity for delegates to express their stance and ideologies with respect to the agenda at hand. Its basic framework consists of three parts:

Part 1 — The first part should reflect the history and introduction of the agenda, as seen through the particular portfolio's eyes.

Part 2 — The second part is used for establishing the stance of the portfolio while also mentioning the past actions taken by them to address the agenda.

Part 3 — The third part is considered the most important, as it gives the basic outline for the actions that the portfolio wishes to take in committee to resolve issues. All delegates are advised not to omit this part in their position paper.

Formatting & Submission Requirements

The position paper should be over 2 pages in length and does not have a page limit. The font should be E.B. Garamond, size 12. The position paper must contain a separate bibliography section, where each delegate must provide links to the research material used to write their paper (MLA-8 Citation format). Please note that the bibliography section is not included in the page limit.

Important: SMUN has a very strict No Plagiarism and AI policy, and all delegates must adhere to it at all times during the conference. Delegates found to have used plagiarised content in their position papers shall be marked down by the Executive Board. Using any content other than their own during committee, without proper reference, will also be deemed as plagiarised.

Note: The deadline for the position paper is 11:59 PM on April 18th, 2026. No delays will be entertained. Kindly mail it as a PDF file to: ssloksabha2026.smun@gmail.com

Sample —

https://drive.google.com/file/d/1W_wWsIzRSSvcpiN0_rLsxtgGwpcUUsNN/view?usp=sharing

B. PRESS RELEASE

A press release is a statement issued by a member of a committee to inform the public about a certain plan of action, an announcement, or any other information pertaining to the agenda. A press release is issued in committee by delegates in order to put forth their policies and plans with respect to the agenda or a crisis, by first stating the issue followed by the information that a particular portfolio may wish to announce to the public.

A press release may be written individually. However, for the purposes of committee, a Joint Press Release will also be entertained. A Joint Press Release is a statement issued collectively by two or more politicians, written to convey a similar stance, a jointly undertaken action, or an agreement between both parties.

Format

Author/s Signatories(if joint)	Press Release (specify if Joint)
Body	

C. MEMORANDUM

A memorandum refers to a written communication from a delegate to those under their authority. It is used to convey important information, a plan of action that has been carried out, or to request information from those under the portfolio's authority. A memorandum can be made public if it assumes significant importance with regard to the present circumstances.

A memorandum typically begins with a precise opening statement providing a brief background regarding its subject. Following this, the delegate is expected to cite the reasons that triggered the need for the information or the change in the plan of action being stated. The memorandum should then contain the plan of action to be undertaken.

Note: Memorandums that are precise, to the point, and comprehensive are highly regarded by the Executive Board.

Memorandum
Author
Signatories(if required)
Body

D. CHITS

For the purposes of the committee, the Executive Board will be looking at two types of chits:

Points of Information Chits

These chits must be used when a delegate wishes to ask another delegate a question regarding a speech made, but is unable to do so verbally. Points of Information chits can be sent directly to a delegate or can be sent via the Executive Board if the delegate wishes to inform the Directors about the question being asked. Please specify from and to.

Lobbying Chits

Delegates may utilise lobbying chits to negotiate with other delegates. These chits serve as the basic means to negotiate and discuss party policy, share solutions, form blocs, and communicate informally with other delegates present in the committee.

Important: Lobbying chits are meant only for informal communication and must not be sent via the Executive Board.

E. COMMUNIQUÉS

A communiqué is a statement written by a delegate in committee to any person of their choice outside of the committee. It serves as official communication between the two parties and must contain a set of instructions that help undertake an action, given by the delegate to the recipient.

Note: The Executive Board will be entertaining both private communiqués (the content of which will be kept confidential and not revealed in committee) and public communiqués. In the scenario of a communiqué without a heading specifying whether it is

public or private, it shall be treated as a public communiqué by default and will be read out during committee.

Sample -

<https://drive.google.com/file/d/1SppaqMdWlg9AKljK1DUg4pmT1jadyTI/view?usp=sharing>

F. FINAL DOCUMENTATION

Final documentation represents the formal, concluding output of the committee's deliberations. Delegates may produce final documentation in the form of a Draft Resolution, Working Paper, or Bill.

The specific type of final documentation to be used in this committee will be announced by the Executive Board at the commencement of proceedings. Delegates are advised to remain attentive to this announcement before beginning to draft their final documentation.

PART III | QUESTIONS A RESOLUTION MUST ANSWER

The Questions a Resolution Must Answer (QARMA) essentially serve as a guide to formulate solution-based documentation or speeches, and consist of the core issues for the committee to solve. **Please note: this is a starting point, and delegates are expected to go beyond these questions and not necessarily confine themselves to the points below.**

1. How should the Indian Parliament precisely define and legally codify the threshold between an 'act of terrorism' and an 'act of war,' and what constitutional and legislative framework should govern India's response to each?
2. What legal safeguards, if any, should be incorporated into the Prevention of Terrorism Act (POTA) to ensure that its provisions against unlawful detention, surveillance, and confession do not violate the Fundamental Rights guaranteed under Articles 19, 20, 21, and 22 of the Indian Constitution?
3. What reforms should be undertaken within organisations such as the Intelligence Bureau and Research and Analysis Wing to address the intelligence and security failures that allowed the attack of 13 December 2001 to succeed?

4. What long-term legislative, judicial, and counter-terrorism reforms should the Thirteenth Lok Sabha enact to ensure that the sovereignty of India's democratic institutions is never again threatened by domestic or international terror or militant networks?
5. How should the Indian government communicate with and reassure its citizens in the aftermath of the attack, and what measures should be taken to prevent the spread of communal tension and violence across the country?
6. How should India reform its border management and infiltration prevention mechanisms to prevent trained militants from entering Indian territory?

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